



MOAR

Platforms: Xbox One, Microsoft Windows

Price: Xbox One & PC: Rs. 3,999

Reviewed on: Xbox One

Developers: The Coalition

Publishers: Microsoft Studios

Pros:

- Interesting story
- Great visuals
- Fun gameplay with stunning set pieces
- Split-screen co-op

Cons:

- Short campaign

moments, hoard mode and the standard corridor shooting. There are some vehicle moments in the game too, a nice break from the standard cover based shooting.

Moving on to online, there are the standard slew of modes, including hoard mode for you to enjoy. If you have played any of the previous Gears games, you will be right at home in multiplayer. The advantage gamers have with the shot-gun in multiplayer is slightly unfair but then again, I ain't that great a player when it comes to GOW online.

GRAPHICS

This is the first action adventure game that I have played that is based on the Unreal Engine 4. Put simply the game looks gorgeous. We played the game on the Xbox One S and even though we didn't have an HDR capable TV during the process of reviewing the game, the game looks great in SDR. If you remember, Gears of War 1 and 2 had a grey scale colour scheme. With Gears of War 4, the colour scheme is not only diverse but vibrant too. From the blue in the armour of the lead protagonist to the red in the storm and the green of the forests, the environments in the game look great. It's needless to say that we can't

There was no noticeable stutter or frame rate drop even in the high octane action sequences. The game runs at a solid 30 FPS in single player and 60FPS in multiplayer on the Xbox One.

Visually, Gears of War 4 is a game that you can really appreciate.

SOUND

Getting the worst out of the way, I personally didn't like the voice acting of the lead protagonist. The developers have tried to make him a Gears version of Nathan Drake but it hasn't turned out like that. Also the fact that as long as Marcus is on screen he overshadows everyone else. Apart from that, the sound quality of the game is what you'd expect from a Gears game. From the whirling of the chainsaw as you cut through enemies to the sound of rapid fire during gun fights, the sound is immersive. There isn't a quiet moment in the game and that's good in a way considering how fast paced it is.

OVERALL

The only drawback is that the story ends in about 8 hours in Normal difficulty. The campaign isn't long but if you have a friend visiting there is reason to play it in split screen co-op. Add to it the

War 4 is good. There are obvious plot twists and turns but the way they have been executed will keep you engaged and entertained.

GAMEPLAY

Anyone who has played a Gears of War game will feel right at home here. The cover based shooting mechanics haven't changed much throughout the life of the franchise but there are some cool additions in Gears of War 4. To begin with, you can now grab an enemy that's hidden behind cover and stab him with the knife. The movement between cover to cover feels smoother.

The gameplay is linear just as we have seen in the Uncharted franchise and previous Gears of War games. What will keep you going is how well the game is paced between set-piece



wait to see what developers do with the Unreal Engine 4 especially when you consider the fact that we have games like the Batman: Arkham series, Borderlands, Battleborn, Mortal Kombat X and more based on the Unreal Engine 3.

There are times when you see patchy textures, or texture pop-ins but these are far and few. The reason they are so noticeable is because the overall game is so beautiful.

fact that the online multiplayer can keep you going for about 100 hours and you have a value for money proposition. Split screen co-op makes gaming with friends on the days the Internet isn't working a lot of fun. If you own an Xbox One, then you should definitely check out Gears of War 4. Its campaign is fresh enough to entertain newcomers and has enough to keep fans of the franchise happy, just like the Force Awakens. *